



MILESTONE 1 PROGRESS PRESENTATION

S.H.I.E.L.D.

System for High Integrity Elimination of Low-Altitude Drones

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Faculty Advisor: Dr. Madhur Tiwari · Client: Dr. Firat Irmak

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Milestone 1 Progress

Task	Status	Remaining
Compare and select technical tools	Done	None
"Hello world" demos	Done	None
Resolve technical challenges	90%	AI.Panther access for training
Compare and select collaboration tools	Done	None
Requirement Document	Done	None
Design Document	Done	None
Test Plan	Done	None

Technical Tools Selected

EDGE COMPUTER

NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano Super

67 TOPS GPU. Reuses the unit on Dr. Tiwari's drone, replacing the unvalidated Hailo-8 plan.

CAMERA

e-CAM25_CUNOX (AR0234)

Global shutter avoids motion skew on fast targets; 1080p at up to 120 fps.

DETECTOR

YOLO26s

Chosen from a weighted matrix of YOLOv8, v11 and v26 (n/s/m). NMS-free and built for edge devices.

TRACKING

ByteTrack + Kalman filter

Persistent IDs through brief occlusion, with constant-velocity smoothing and prediction.

EMULATION

Unity 6 virtual camera

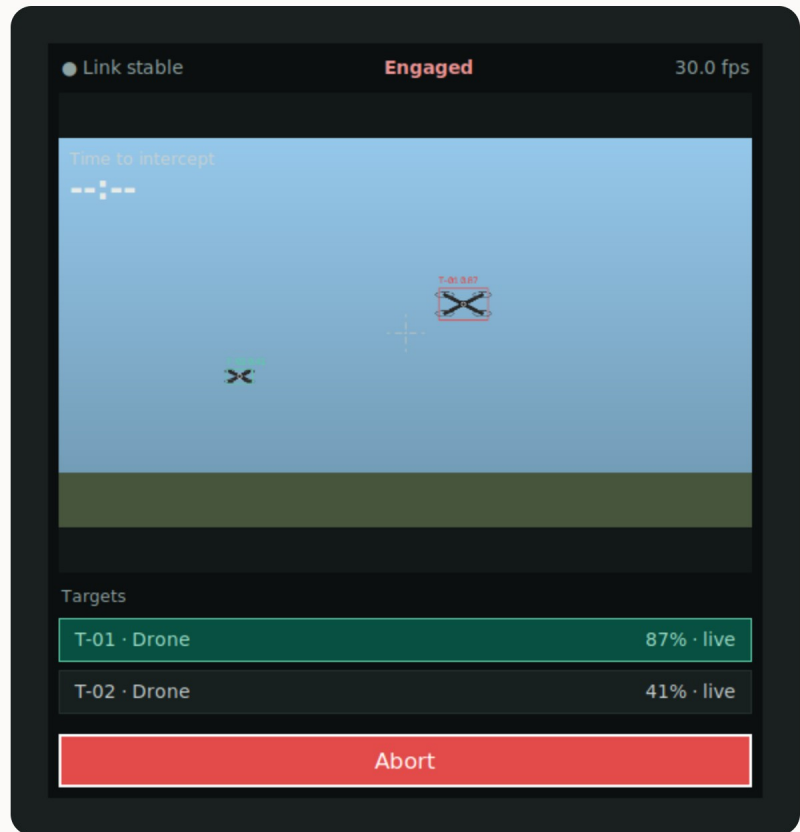
Streams rendered frames over TCP so the pipeline runs before the hardware exists.

TESTING

STE (WinUI3 + VB.NET)

Runs scripted, requirement-traced test cases and logs PASS/FAIL for every check.

"Hello World" Demos



- End-to-end emulation pipeline: YOLO → ByteTrack → Kalman filter, on a webcam, a video file, or the Unity virtual camera.
- Custom two-class model (drone, balloon) replaces the stock COCO weights; a yolo11n stand-in runs until YOLO26s is retrained.
- Ground control station window: live HUD, target list, and Engage/Abort gated at 25% confidence (AVS.03).

9,738

training images: three Kaggle sets plus 2,000 Unity-rendered synthetic frames

Collaboration Tools



GitHub

Version control and the project website.



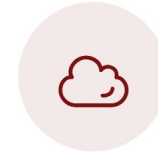
Microsoft Teams

Communication with the AEE team.



Visual Studio

Python pipeline, C# STE app, VB.NET test scripts.



OneDrive + Docs

Shared team files; documents drafted and exported to PDF.

Requirements: AVS Subsystem

ID	Requirement	Rationale
AVS.01	The drone shall be capable of detecting a target within 20 meters.	FPV drones carry 0.3–5 kg of explosives, and the DHS evacuation distance for a 5 lb explosive is ~21 m.
AVS.02	The drone shall recognize and track a target with a minimum span of 0.25 m.	The most commonly used kamikaze drones have a span of ~0.25 m or larger.
AVS.03	The drone shall maintain at least 25 percent confidence while en route to the target.	Provides continuous verification after the operator approves engagement, allowing an abort on a false positive if the track degrades.
AVS.04	The drone's onboard computing system shall process target detection within 33.33 ms of receiving the data from the onboard vision system.	Real-time detection is particularly important for an effective C-UAS. This will ensure that the system is acting on current information.
AVS.05	The drone shall receive engage and abort commands from the Ground Control System.	A "control station" is defined in 14 CFR Part 107, and there must be a remote pilot in command.
AVS.05.01	The drone shall send a heartbeat to the Ground Control System at a rate of 1 Hz.	The Ground Control System must have the status of the drone at all times. 1 Hz is the standard rate.

Functional: AVS.01–02 · Performance: AVS.03–04 · Interface: AVS.05, AVS.05.01. Each is traced to at least one STE test case.

Test Plan

Three stages

1 • Emulation

STE relaunches Unity and the pipeline for every case and logs each check against its requirement.

2 • Hardware bench (M2)

Same scripts and timing checks on the Jetson Orin Nano.

3 • Flight

Balloon under a target drone in the Vertex cage: stationary, then vertical, then lateral.

Test case	Status
T01 Detection range & size	Automated
T02 False positives	Automated
T03 Confidence en route	Automated
T04 Detection latency	Automated (PC); Jetson in M2
T05 Track persistence	Planned, M2
T06 Engagement gating	Manual now; script in M2
T07 Abort, disengage, override	Stub; needs telemetry link
T08 Heartbeat & link loss	Link loss done; heartbeat stub
T09 Sources & platform modes	Planned, M2
T10 Moving target	Unity in M2; flight in spring

Technical Challenges

Pending

Training compute

My GPU is too slow to train YOLO26s model with large dataset. Access to the AI.Panther HPC cluster is requested, submitted by Dr. Irmak.

Planned, M2

Unproven edge hardware

Jetson Orin Nano benchmarks exist for YOLO, but I still have to test our entire detection pipeline on hardware to catch any issues early.

Planned, M2

Sustained real-time

Worst-case frame time and thermal throttling over a 6-minute flight, not just the average, must stay under 33.33 ms.

Feedback Incorporated

Client: Dr. Irmak

- Reuse the existing Jetson Orin Nano, no \$1,000 computer → **adopted**
- Camera of at least 30 fps → **AVS.04 budget**
- Manual takeover at any time → **GCS design**
- Two disengage modes: land or shut down → **GCS, M2**
- Balloon target: stationary, vertical, lateral → **test plan T10**

Advisor: Dr. Tiwari

- Develop detection and GNC separately, integrate at the end → **interface defined in M2**
- Research classical CV such as template matching → **reviewed; YOLO26s kept as detector**

Milestone 2 Plan (Oct 26)

01

Complete STE

Finish the test harness and write test scripts for every AVS requirement.

02

Train YOLO26s

Retrain the drone/balloon model on AI.Panther.

03

Benchmark on Jetson

TensorRT INT8; worst-case latency and thermal throttling.

04

Moving targets

Spawning and motion scripts in the Unity test scenes.

05

Manual override

GCS controls, with land and shut-down modes.

06

GNC interface

Define the target-state message sent to GNC at 30 Hz.

Questions?

brysonnoble.github.io/SHIELD